

Washington State Sample Selection Memorandum -- SKIP JUSTIFICATION FILE CALIBRATION

Engagement PE-2025-014

Engagement

PE-2025-014 -- Chaldale Harbor District performance

audit

Workpaper ref

CHD-A-07

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Fieldwork start

2025-01-01

Subject

Selection of skip justification files for calibration scoring

PURPOSE

This memorandum documents the selection of the 40 skip justification files to be scored in the 2025-Q3 calibration session, and the composition of the sample as between flagged items and random draws. It supports workpapers CHD-A-04 (out-of-turn assignment test) and CHD-A-09 (calibration scoring sheets).

POPULATION

The test population is the 645 slip assignments made in the audit window from the 1486 offer events exported by the District, of which 41 were flagged in the out-of-turn assignment test. The remaining non-flagged assignments number 604. Skip justification files exist for the 412 skip events in the District's export; each file consists, at minimum, of a cover sheet and is expected, under Standing Order 15-3, to include the supporting record.

SELECTION METHOD

The sample of 40 files comprises two strata. First, 28 files were drawn from the auditor's flagged items -- the skip files associated with the 41 out-of-turn items, taking every flagged item for which a skip file exists (28 of 41). Second, 12 files were drawn at random from the remaining 604 assignments using a seeded selection (seed 20250701) applied to the sorted assignment list; the selection is reproducible from the workpaper.

The resulting composition -- 28 flagged + 12 random = 40 files -- was reviewed by the supervisor and is intended to give the scoring panel both the population of interest and an unbiased control group. The four files previously identified as cover-sheet-only (WL-02211, WL-02618, WL-03044, WL-03390) fall within the flagged stratum.

SCORING PROTOCOL SUMMARY

Each file is scored independently by three scorers on three criteria (reason-code validity, file completeness on the day the slip was worked, and arithmetic consistency with the register), producing up to 9 scores per file where all three scorers assess all three criteria. The session is planned for two passes; disagreements not unanimous on the first pass are resolved on the second. The documentation standard applied is Resolution 2022-06 section 4.3 as limited by its section 4.4, together with Standing Order 15-3 and the principle of Appeal 2018-3 that the file as it stood on the day the slip was worked controls.

REPRODUCIBILITY

The sorted assignment list, the flagged-item list, and the random draw are retained in the engagement file. Any reviewer can reproduce the selection from the seed and the sort order stated above.